Partial doubles are useful, but we consider them a *code smell*, a superficial sign that might lead you to a deeper design issue.[2] In *Using Partial Doubles Effectively*, on page 271, we'll explain some of these underlying issues and how to address them.

Verifying Doubles

The upside of test doubles is that they can stand in for a dependency you don't want to drag into your test. The downside is that the double and the dependency can drift out of sync with each other.[3] *Verifying doubles* can protect you from this kind of drift.

In *Test Doubles: Mocks, Stubs, and Others*, on page 67, you created a test double to help you test a high-level API when your lower-level Ledger class didn't exist yet. We later explained that you were using a verifying double for that spec; let's take a closer look at why it was important to do so.

Here's a simplified version of a similar double, *without* verification:

13-understanding-test-doubles/02/expense_tracker/spec/unit/ledger_double_spec.rb

```
ledger = double('ExpenseTracker::Ledger')
allow(ledger).to receive(:record)
```

When you tested your system's public API, your routing code called Ledger#record:

13-understanding-test-doubles/02/expense_tracker/app/api.rb

```
post '/expenses' do
  expense = JSON.parse(request.body.read)
  result = @ledger.record(expense)
  JSON.generate('expense_id' => result.expense_id)
end
```

The Ledger class didn't exist yet; the test double provided enough of an implementation for your routing specs to pass. Later, you built the real thing.

Consider what would happen if at some point you renamed the Ledger#record method to Ledger#record_expense but forgot to update the routing code. Your specs would still pass, since they're still providing a fake record method. But your code would fail in real-world use, because it's trying to call a method that no longer exists. These kinds of false positives can kill confidence in your unit specs.

You avoided this trap in the expense tracker project by using a verifying double. To do so, you called instance_double in place of double, passing the name of the Ledger class. Here's a stripped-down version of the code:

2. https://martinfowler.com/bliki/CodeSmell.html
3. https://www.thoughtworks.com/insights/blog/mockists-are-dead-long-live-classicists